

KAT DE JESUS CHUA

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

2016- 2020

Bachelor of Arts in Data Science
Minor in Russian Literature

Sarah Lawrence College

Expected 2027- 2029

Master of Fine Arts in Writing
Admitted in 2026; enrollment deferred to Fall 2027

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Scientist

Warner Bros. Discovery

Sep 2020 – Nov 2025

- Partnered with Product and Data Engineering teams to build next-genre prediction models from viewing data, improving the accuracy of personalized recommendations for subscribers of HBO Max streaming platform.
- Developed machine-learning models forecasting comic sales, reducing prediction error by 43.5% versus legacy manual processes and informing DC Comics' biannual product approval decisions.
- Built a Python deep-learning pipeline in TensorFlow on Microsoft Azure to perform video super-resolution, upscaling vintage television footage to HD for remastering.

JOURNALISM & EDITORIAL EXPERIENCE

Volunteer Data Journalist & Developer

[Data Liberation Project](#)

Mar 2024 - Present

- Built Python pipelines to create the first machine-readable [archive of TSA traveler complaint data](#); built web-scraping tools [extracting emissions data from Texas air-permit records](#), enabling journalists to quickly investigate trends and issues.
- Wrote a [public explainer](#) on the removal of TSA complaint data in early 2025.

Chicago Documenter

[City Bureau](#)

Jan 2025 – Present

- Created [accurate, detailed, publicly available records](#) of Chicago government meetings, neighborhood councils, and pretrial detention hearings, as part of the 3,700+ member [Documenters network](#)

Fiction Submissions Reader

[Same Faces Collective](#)

Jul 2025 – Present

- Reviewed and evaluated fiction submissions for the literary magazine, providing constructive feedback on theme, voice, style, and narrative strength; committed ~4 hours per week during reading periods.

SKILLS

Data Analysis & Visualization: Python (NumPy, pandas, scikit-learn, statsmodels, seaborn), R (ggplot2, threejs, forecast, dplyr, tidyverse, data.table), SQL (Snowflake, BigQuery), Jupyter, Git, Databricks, Tableau
Project & Collaboration: Cross-functional collaboration, project management, stakeholder communication
Writing & Editorial: Narrative data storytelling, technical writing, copy editing, fiction evaluation

AWARDS

- **Pushcart Prize Nominee (2024).** Nominated for short story “The Last Dinner Party,” published by *Same Faces Collective* literary magazine.
- **Gary Marx Fellowship, Investigative Reporters & Editors Inc.** Awarded prestigious fellowship for early career journalists.

PUBLICATIONS

- **“The Last Dinner Party.”** *Same Faces Collective* Issue 16, “Re:Vision.” Fiction.
- **“The Proposal.”** [Missed Connections: Microfiction from Asia](#). Flash fiction.
- **“The fiesta away from home.”** [Philippines Graphic](#) Volume 26. Poetry.

CLASSES & CONFERENCES

StoryStudio Chicago – “Creative Writing Essentials” Jul 2025 – Aug 2025

- Completed a creative writing course taught by author Sarah Terez Rosenblum, including intensive workshops. Produced weekly writing and reading assignments and contributed to in-depth discussions of craft and narrative technique.

Investigative Reporters & Editors Inc.’s NICAR Conference Mar 2025

- Attended the National Institute for Computer-Assisted Reporting conference in Minneapolis, MN, sponsored by the Gary Marx Scholarship from IRE. Gained hands-on exposure to data journalism, including data analysis applications in reporting, writing data-driven stories, and foundational investigative journalism techniques.

The Writer’s Grotto – “Write Short Stories Like the Masters” Nov 2022 – Dec 2022

- Completed a fiction workshop taught by author Jenny Bitner. Wrote and workshopped an original short story, provided and received weekly peer feedback, and submitted reading-response assignments on selected short stories.